Statements describing your work experience can be made forceful and persuasive if you use action verbs, such as those listed in Figure 13.3 and illustrated in Figure 13.4. Starting each of your bullet points with an action verb will help ensure that your bulleted lists are parallel.

FIGURE 13.3 Action Verbs for Powerful Résumés

The underlined words are especially good for pointing out accomplishments.

Communication Skills

arbitrated
arranged
authored
clarified
collaborated
convinced
corresponded
defined
developed
directed
drafted
edited
enlisted
explained
formulated
influenced
integrated
interpreted
mediated
moderated
negotiated
participated
persuaded
promoted
publicized
reconciled
recruited
resolved
spoke
specified
suggested
summarized
translated
wrote

Teamwork, Supervision Skills

adapted
advised
assessed
assisted
clarified
coached
collaborated (with)
communicated
coordinated
counseled
demonstrated
demystified
developed
enabled
encouraged
evaluated
expedited
explained
facilitated
guided
informed
instructed
motivated
persuaded
set goals
stimulated
teamed (with)
trained

Management, Leadership Skills

administered
analyzed
assigned
attained
authorized
chaired
consolidated
contracted
coordinated
delegated
developed
directed
evaluated
executed
handled
headed
implemented
improved
increased
led
modeled
organized
oversaw
planned
prioritized
produced
recommended
reorganized
reviewed
scheduled
strengthened
supervised
trained

Research Skills

analyzed
clarified
collected
critiqued
diagnosed
evaluated
examined
experimented
extracted
formulated
gathered
identified
informed
inspected
interpreted
interviewed
invented
investigated
located
measured
observed
organized
researched
reviewed
searched
solved
studied
summarized
surveyed
systematized

Clerical, Detail Skills

activated
approved
arranged
catalogued
classified
collected
compiled
edited
executed
generated
implemented
inspected
logged
maintained
monitored
operated
organized
prepared
processed
proofread
purchased
recorded
retrieved
screened
specified
streamlined
systematized
tabulated
updated
validated

Creative Skills

acted
conceptualized
created
customized
designed
developed
directed
established
fashioned
founded
illustrated
initiated
instituted
integrated
introduced
invented
originated
performed
planned
revitalized
shaped

Technical Skills

assembled
built
calculated
computed
configured
designed
devised
engineered
fabricated
installed
maintained
operated
overhauled
performed troubleshooting
programmed
remodeled
repaired
retrieved
solved
upgraded

Financial Skills

administered
allocated
analyzed
appraised
audited
balanced
budgeted
calculated
computed
developed
forecast
managed
marketed
planned
projected
researched

More Accomplishment Verbs

achieved
expanded
improved
pioneered
reduced (losses)
resolved (problems)
restored
revamped
spearheaded

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